

Q1 2026

POLK COUNTY REGION INDUSTRIAL MARKET REPORT



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THE
Ruthvens

POLK COUNTY REGION AT A GLANCE



Total Available SF
7,796,818 SF



Net Absorption
347,293 SF



Vacancy
7.10%



Under Construction
1,543,072 SF



New Delivery
604,436 SF



Total Sublet
40,704 SF



Total Sales
\$41,577,922.00



Average Sales Price
\$111.00 / SF

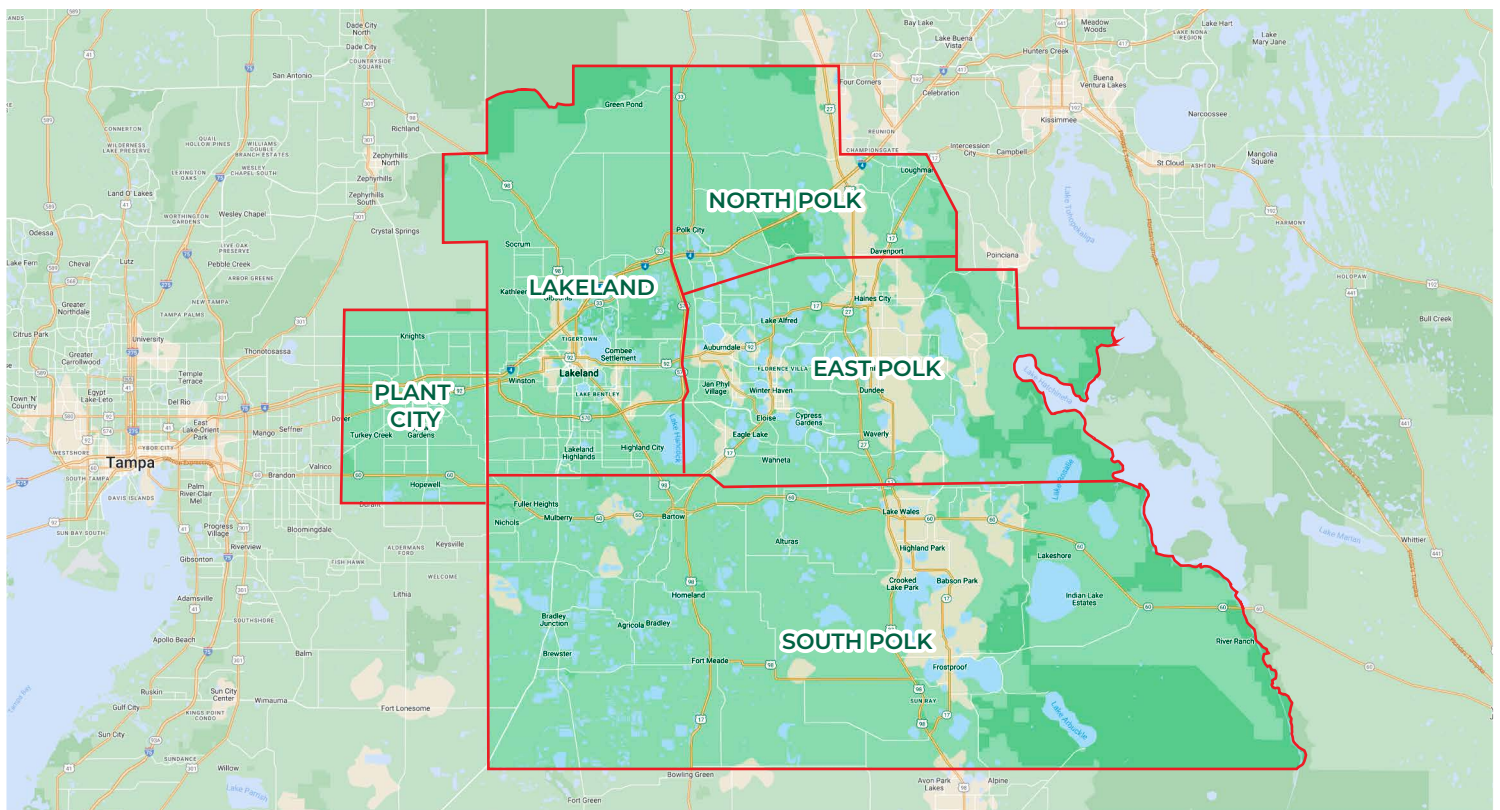


Average Cap Rate
7.40%

Source: CoStar, Ruthvens

MARKET OVERVIEW

The industrial market entered Q1 2026 with a notable shift toward stabilization following a high-velocity period. Total available inventory tightened to 7.80M SF, with vacancies remaining stable at 7.10%, while construction activity moderated to 1.54M SF, a 14% decrease from Q4, but consistent with the last three quarters. Despite a significant 60% dip in total sales volume to \$41.5M, pricing remains resilient with average sales climbing to \$111/SF. Net absorption saw a healthy 8% increase, regardless of a massive 197% surge in new deliveries totaling 604,436 SF (80% from Pace 570 and 20% from small bay in WH). Cap rates remain stable at 7.40%, reflecting a nuanced recalibration as the market absorbs recent supply and investors prioritize asset quality.



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SUBMARKET STATISTICS

	Polk County	Lakeland	East Polk	North Polk	South Polk	Plant City
INVENTORY SF	94.7M ↑	51M ↑	22.6M ↑	10.5M ↑	10.4M ↑	22.7M ↓
LEASE TRANSACTIONS						
Available SF	7.8M ↓	5.2M ↑	849K ↑	927K ↓	827K ↑	2.8M ↓
Net Absorption	347K ↑	-32.7K ↓	145K ↑	384K ↑	-6.5K ↓	392K ↑
Average Rent	\$9.35 ↑	\$9.41 ↑	\$9.38 ↑	\$8.97 ↑	\$9.38 ↑	\$9.86 ↓
Sublet	47K ↑	37K ↑	0 —	0 —	3.2K —	330K ↓
Vacancy	7.10% ↑	8.00% —	2.80% ↓	11.30% ↑	7.90% ↑	9.50% ↓
NEW CONSTRUCTION						
New Delivery	604K ↑	0 ↓	108K —	496K —	0 ↓	0 ↓
Under Construction	1.5M ↓	1.1M ↑	164.5K ↑	267K —	6.9K ↑	0 —
SALES TRANSACTIONS						
Sales	14 ↓	8 ↓	4 ↓	0 ↓	2 ↓	2 ↓
Average \$/SF	\$106 ↑	\$116 ↓	\$126 ↑	- —	\$73 ↓	\$123 ↓
Cap Rate	6.80% ↓	7.20% ↓	6.40% ↓	-% —	6.70% ↓	6.20% ↓
LEASING RATES (PSF)						
Class A	\$8.84 ↑	\$8.81 ↑	\$9.21 ↑	\$8.92 ↑	\$7.46 ↑	\$9.36 ↓
Class B	\$9.70 ↑	\$9.80 ↑	\$9.55 ↑	\$9.01 ↑	\$9.81 ↑	\$10.13 ↓
Class C	\$9.69 ↑	\$10.14 ↑	\$9.33 ↑	\$10.82 ↑	\$9.54 ↑	\$10.79 ↓

Source: CoStar, Ruthvens

HIGHLIGHTED TRANSACTIONS

SALES						
TYPE	ADDRESS, CITY	SOLD	PURCHASED PRICE	SF	\$/SF	BUILT
Warehouse / IOS	5004 N Combee Rd, Lakeland	02/16/2026	\$1,900,000.00	10,975	\$173.12	1977
Warehouse	2006 National Guard Dr, Plant City	03/05/2026	\$2,100,000.00	16,864	\$124.53	1990
Warehouse / IOS	96 Hwy 17, Haines City	03/10/2026	\$2,200,000.00	20,899	\$105.27	1968
IOS	1025 N Chestnut Rd, Lakeland	01/21/2026	\$4,500,000.00	25,800	\$174.42	1990
Warehouse	3620 Airport Rd, Lakeland	01/28/2026	\$3,600,000.00	30,600	\$117.65	2014
Cold Storage	1005 Snively Ave, Winter Haven	01/19/2026	\$5,213,300.00	53,184	\$98.12	1970
Warehouse	5115 N Frontage Rd, Lakeland	02/03/2026	\$7,846,160.00	56,044	\$140.00	1971
LEASES						
TYPE	ADDRESS, CITY	SIGNED DATE	TENANT	SF	\$/SF	BUILT
Warehouse	111 Industrial Blvd, Winter Haven	01/16/2026	Boys Electrical	14,250	\$10.00	2004
Warehouse	3130 Reynolds Rd, Lakeland	01/01/2026	Confidential	15,000	\$12.00	1984
Warehouse	3115 Drane Field Rd, Lakeland	01/09/2026	Confidential	25,600	-	2000
Warehouse	304 Winston Creek Pkwy, Lakeland	03/03/2026	Cornerstone Equipment	31,000	\$10.00	1981
Warehouse	3900 County Line Rd, Lakeland	01/20/2026	Confidential	65,000	-	2025
Warehouse	1050 Pace Center Dr, Auburndale	01/29/2026	The Florida Brewery	77,395	-	2026
Warehouse	3602 Fancy Farms Rd, Plant City	03/26/2026	LG	282,639	\$7.71	2019

R - Ruthven Deal

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SUBMARKET LEASE INVENTORY

This report is a breakdown of the current leasing inventory for industrial and flex in the Polk County market and submarkets (refer to map on page 1), based on the inventory available at the end of the quarter, by the following items:

1. Q - Quantity of spaces: total of separate leasable space available, as being marketed online (buildings and spaces are subject to be demised or combined as needed), i.e. spaces between 10,000 SF and 24,999 SF.
2. SF - Total square footage per space range, all available space combined per category.

			LOCATION																	
			POLK COUNTY			LAKELAND			EAST POLK			NORTH POLK			SOUTH POLK			PLANT CITY		
STATUS		EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	EXISTING	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	PROPOSED	
SQUARE FOOTAGE RANGE / SPACE	0 to 2.4K	Q	64	0	0	25	0	0	38	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	3	0	0
		SF	112K	0	0	43K	0	0	67K	0	0	0	0	0	1.5K	0	0	3.6K	0	0
	2.5K to 4.9K	Q	22	13	0	14	13	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	1	0	0
		SF	77K	49K	0	47K	49K	0	24K	0	0	0	0	0	6.4K	0	0	3.5K	0	0
	5K to 9.9K	Q	44	9	1	29	4	1	9	0	0	0	5	0	6	0	0	0	0	0
		SF	295K	63K	5K	193K	30K	5K	60K	0	0	0	33K	0	43K	0	0	0	0	0
	10K to 24K	Q	35	6	5	21	3	3	11	1	2	0	2	0	3	0	0	3	0	1
		SF	573K	74K	74K	345K	42K	45K	177K	10K	29K	0	22K	0	51K	0	0	37K	0	10K
	25K to 49K	Q	16	3	4	9	1	1	3	1	2	3	1	0	1	0	1	2	0	2
		SF	582K	108K	152K	326K	30K	30K	107K	34K	75K	103K	44K	0	47K	0	47K	74K	0	65K
	50K to 99K	Q	9	0	2	5	0	1	2	0	1	2	1	0	0	0	0	4	0	0
		SF	641K	0	118K	355K	0	50K	121K	0	68K	165K	86K	0	0	0	0	226K	0	0
	100K to 249K	Q	12	4	19	9	4	12	1	0	1	0	0	3	2	0	3	6	0	9
		SF	1.7M	771K	3.1M	1.3M	771K	1.9M	132K	0	114K	0	0	527K	264K	0	488K	973K	0	1.8M
	250K to 499K	Q	6	1	4	4	1	2	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	1	3	0	2
		SF	2.6M	261K	1.3M	1.7M	261K	486K	0	0	295K	475K	0	0	371K	0	488K	865K	0	671K
	500K to 999K	Q	0	0	7	0	0	4	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	0
		SF	0	0	5.4M	0	0	3.1M	0	0	1.6M	0	0	0	0	0	750K	536K	0	0
	1M+	Q	0	0	2	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
		SF	0	0	3.7M	0	0	1.6M	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2M	0	0	0

Source: CoStar, Ruthvens

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HIGHLIGHTED INVENTORY

LEASE



167 Delbert Collins Rd, Lake Alfred

From 26,000 SF to 114,400 SF | New Class A

LEASE



4100 Recker Hwy, Winter Haven

From 3,900 - 9,900 SF | Fully HVAC

LEASE



Frostproof Business Park, Frostproof

Class A Build to suit | Rail Served

LEASE



625 W Bridgers Ave, Auburndale

15,000 SF Grade | 33,000 SF Dock & Ramp

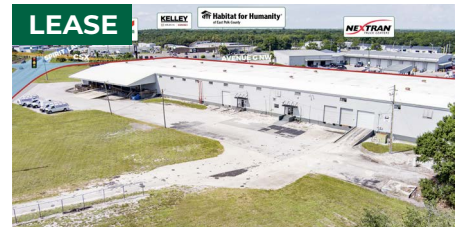
LEASE



500 McKean St, Auburndale

5,781 SF on 5.2 AC | Dock & Ramp

LEASE



701 42nd St NW, Winter Haven

19,800 SF + IOS | Dock & Ramp

LEASE



330 W Brannen Rd, Lakeland

12,120 SF Flex | 1.76 AC IOS | Grade

LEASE



2200 3rd St NW, Winter Haven

From 6,000 to 61,900 SF | Dock

LEASE



850 2nd Lake Ida St, Winter Haven

IOS + Warehouse Available

LEASE



2404 Hunt Brothers Rd, Lake Wales

Up to 108,984 SF | 3ph, 480V, 2,000 Amps

LEASE



5351 Great Oak Dr, Lakeland

2,146-4,148 SF Flex Space | 2 min from I-4

SALE



1310 E Canal St, Mulberry

2,400 SF Flex Warehouse | High Traffic

SALE / LEASE



3310 Reynolds Rd, Lakeland

27,360 SF | Showroom | Dock & Ramp

SALE



0 County Rd 542, Winter Haven

25 Usable AC | BPC-1

SALE



3435 Recker Hwy, Winter Haven

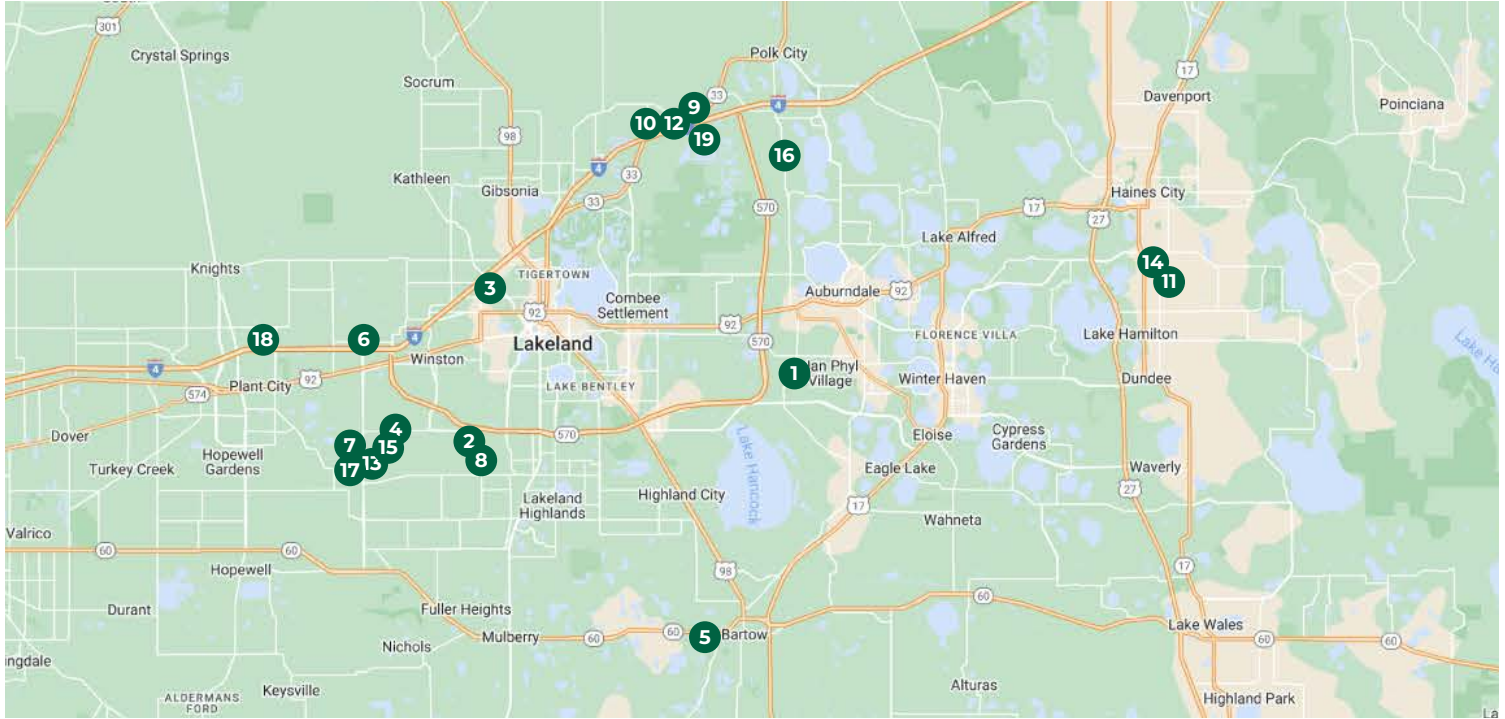
2,940 SF on 0.92 AC | LCC Zoning | Grade

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LAND ANALYSIS

This report is an overview of recent industrial development either under construction, partially completed, or completed, with the comparison of cost by acre, cost for buildable square footage and a site overview.

The price is based on the purchase price at the time of the sale, and the total planned/built square footage, which may not include underground utilities, entitlement and permitting cost, clearing and grading, and other site improvements, which sometimes can be as much or more than the land cost.



#	ADDRESS	AC	BUILDING TYPE	TOTAL SF	SALE DATE	\$/BSF	\$/AC	STATUS
1	US Hwy 542 W, Winter Haven	1.7	Warehouse - Grade	17,800	Q4-22	\$11.80	\$123,529.41	Completed
2	3929 Pipkin Rd, Lakeland	4.27	Flex - Grade	49,154	Q1-22	\$11.19	\$128,805.62	Under Construction
3	1530 Kendrick Ln, Lakeland	4.36	Flex - Grade	70,000	Q1-23	\$18.57	\$298,165.14	Under Construction
4	3955 Anchuca Dr, Lakeland	8.14	Warehouse - Dock	84,000	Q1-23	\$11.90	\$122,850.12	Under Construction
5	1595 Centennial Blvd, Bartow	19.00	Warehouse - Dock	93,600	Q1-22	\$7.75	\$38,157.89	Completed
6	5137 Swindell Rd, Lakeland	8.52	Warehouse - Dock	100,800	Q1-24	\$32.74	\$387,323.94	Under Construction
7	3900 S County Line Rd, Lakeland	12.17	Warehouse - Dock	156,000	Q4-23	\$17.95	\$230,073.95	Completed
8	4210 S Pipkin Rd, Lakeland	8.22	Warehouse - Dock	156,386	Q3-22	\$14.71	\$279,805.35	Completed
9	8529 SR 33, Lakeland	15.00	Warehouse - Dock	172,392	Q1-25	\$13.20	\$151,666.67	Under Construction
10	8515 State Rd 33, Lakeland	23.51	Warehouse - Dock	172,392	Q3-25	\$20.88	\$153,126.33	Under Construction
11	2998 Bannon Island Rd, Haines City	38.02	Warehouse - Dock	174,000	Q2-24	\$20.11	\$92,056.81	Completed
12	8161 State Rd 33 N, Lakeland	28.18	Warehouse - Dock	201,420	Q3-08	\$6.70	\$47,906.32	Completed
13	4320 County Line Rd, Lakeland	19.09	Warehouse - Dock/Grade	221,650	Q2-24	\$14.21	\$165,007.86	Completed
14	205 Depot Way, Haines City	19.15	Warehouse - Dock	231,920	Q4-22	\$14.41	\$174,563.97	Completed
15	4141/4142 Hamilton Rd, Lakeland	37.95	Warehouse - Dock	317,955	Q4-24	\$11.15	\$93,386.03	Completed
16	1030-1050 Pace Rd, Auburndale	35.49	Warehouse - Dock	401,856	Q1-25	\$9.36	\$106,012.96	Partially Completed
17	3017 S County Line Rd, Plant City	42.55	Warehouse - Dock	535,507	Q2-23	\$13.62	\$171,440.66	Completed
18	1530/1540 N Frontage Rd, Plant City	72.58	Warehouse - Dock	859,748	Q1-23	\$17.45	\$206,668.50	Partially Completed
19	University Blvd, Lakeland	103.99	Warehouse/Flex	1,143,508	Q1-23	\$22.74	\$250,024.04	Under Construction

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SPEC DEVELOPMENT



3955 ANCHUCA DR LAKELAND

Construction Started:	Q3-25
Estimated Completion:	Q3-26
Market:	Lakeland Airport
Total SF:	84,000 SF
Space Available:	6,000 - 24,000 SF
Construction Type:	Tilt-wall
Clear Height:	24'
Loading:	Dock (10'x10') + Ramp
Sprinklers:	ESFR
Power:	3ph, 277/480V
Parking:	1.23/1,000 SF

167 DELBERT COLLINS RD LAKE ALFRED

Construction Started:	Q3-26
Estimated Completion:	Q3-27
Market:	East Polk County
Total SF:	114,400 SF
Space Available:	26,000 - 114,400 SF
Construction Type:	Tilt-wall
Clear Height:	30'
Loading:	Dock (10'x10') + Ramp
Sprinklers:	ESFR
Power:	3ph, 480V
Parking:	1.21/1,000 SF



1030 PACE CENTER DR AUBURNDALE

Completion Date:	April 2026
Market:	North Polk County
Total SF:	104,084 SF
Space Available:	5,460 - 43,852 SF
Construction Type:	Tilt-wall
Clear Height:	24'
Loading:	Dock (10'x10') + Ramp
Sprinklers:	ESFR
Power:	3ph, 277/480V
Parking:	1.70/1,000 SF



MARKET INDICATORS

2.60%

CPI Core
(12-month % change)

3.75%

Federal Funds
(12/11/2025)

4.26%

US 10 Year Treasury Yield
(04/14/2026)

5.50%

Polk Unemployment Rate
(December 2025)

17.6%

Polk Population Growth
(Since 04/01/20)

\$317,178

Polk Home Sale
Price Average (Q4)

\$65,978

Polk Median
Household Income

1,280 / 85

Net Migration to Florida /
Polk per day

WHY CHOOSE POLK COUNTY?

As one of the fastest growing MSA in the US, Polk County offers a pro-business tax climate, low operating costs, and access to over 11 million consumers within 100 miles. Ideally located between two major metros, it offers 3 deepwater seaports, 5 international airports within 75 miles, and 330+ miles of rail, delivering unmatched connectivity. With 7 institutions of higher learning awarding nearly 10,000 degrees annually, companies benefit from a steady pipeline of skilled talent.



ABOUT THE RUTHVENS

Third-generation Lakeland family-run company since 1957 with expertise in developing, managing and leasing industrial space, The Ruthvens own and manage over 4.5 million square feet across 94 buildings of warehouse on the I-4 corridor. Our brokerage services represent an additional 2 million square feet in Polk County. The Ruthvens are strongly involved in community, philanthropic and industry leadership.

ABOUT ALEX

Alex and his team leads the charge on our brokerage properties and services, where he focuses on industrial and flex assets in Polk County with over 10 years experience in real estate and over 200 transactions in the last four years. Alex is known for providing results by creating opportunities through analyzing a problem and finding a durable solution by using all resources available. He is always looking at new ways to add value and skills, and his experience in his craft and in the community is a big reason he's a trusted resource to head up the brokerage properties division at The Ruthvens. His expertise has earned him multiple industry accolades, including CoStar Power Broker, CREXI Top 1% Producer, and Top 150 Commercial Real Estate LinkedIn Influencer, and his education & affiliations includes SIOR Designation, Regional Director & Tech Chair, CCIM Candidate, NAIOP Central Florida and MICP Designation.

ABOUT AJ

Abbas "AJ" Jaffer joined the Brokerage Properties and Services team in March of 2025, bringing with him extensive experience in industrial development and strategic business growth. Prior to this role, he served as the Vice President of Business Development for the Lakeland Economic Development Council (LEDC) for nearly three years. In this capacity, AJ played a key role in attracting high-skill, high-wage industries to Lakeland, working as a trusted partner for prospects, brokers, and developers. He managed the entire regulatory development process for the City and County, overseeing projects from their conceptual stages through to occupancy, and offering ongoing support throughout their life cycle.

For a market and property analysis report, contact Alex or AJ!



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